MIDS301 — GROUP PRESENTATION

CampusShare Storage

The Campus Peer-to-Peer Storage Marketplace

Group 8: Mariama Bah, Alfred Chen, Wendy Chen, Han Jiang, Alexander Lee

Introduction to Information: A Systems and Design Approach

Spring 2026

AGENDA

Presentation Overview

01 **Executive Summary & Problem Statement**
The storage crisis facing international students

02 **Strategy & Competitive Analysis**
Porter's Five Forces, generic strategy & revenue model

03 **Information Design**
Entity-Relationship Diagram — 9 entities, 2 associative

04 **Business Execution**
Value chain mapping & BPMN process model

05 **Critical Reflection & Closing**
Ethics, limitations, future developments

SECTION 01

Executive Summary & Problem Statement

The storage crisis facing 1.1 million international students

The Problem

1.1 million international students — nowhere to store their belongings

Every year, over 1.1 million international students at U.S. universities face the same crisis: when summer arrives, they must vacate campus housing with no practical storage option.

Commercial self-storage is not a real alternative for most students:

The gap: access, not availability. Fellow students hold thousands of sq ft of unused space on the same campus.

$150+

per month
average cost

5+ mi

from campus
typically

0

car access for
most intl students

Sources: IIE (2024); IBISWorld (2024)

Our Solution

.edu-verified peer storage — walking distance, no truck needed

CampusShare Storage is a peer-to-peer marketplace that matches students who need short-term storage with students who have unused space — all within a single university campus.

.edu Identity Wall

Only verified students can participate — both Hosts and Renters belong to the same campus community

Flexible Terms

Book storage for 1 week to 3 months — no long-term contracts, no minimum commitments

On-Campus Handover

Physical item transfer happens at agreed campus locations — no vehicle required

Dual Revenue

Hosts earn passive income on unused space; Renters save vs. commercial alternatives

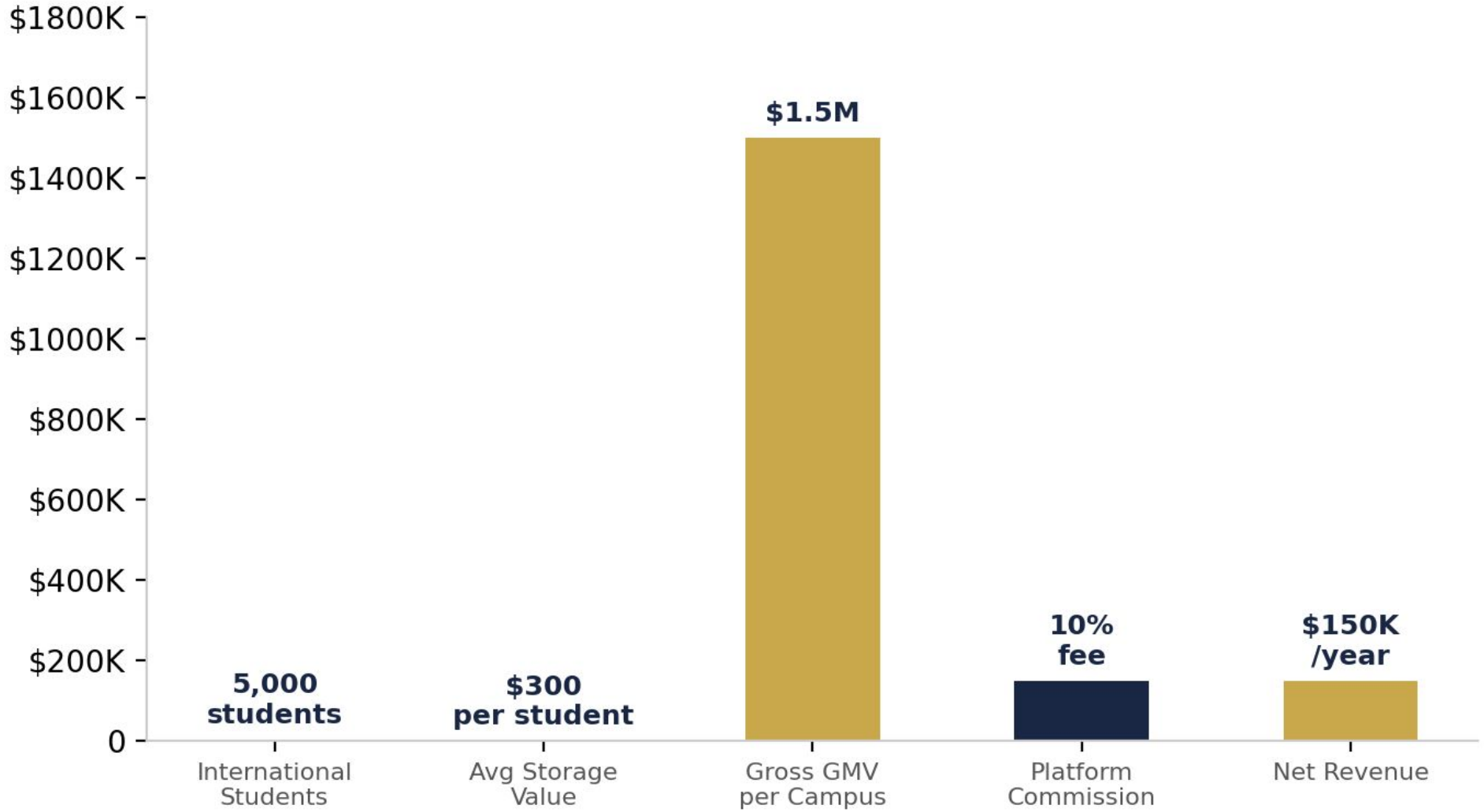
SECTION 02

Strategy & Competitive Analysis

Porter's Five Forces, generic strategy & revenue model

Market Opportunity

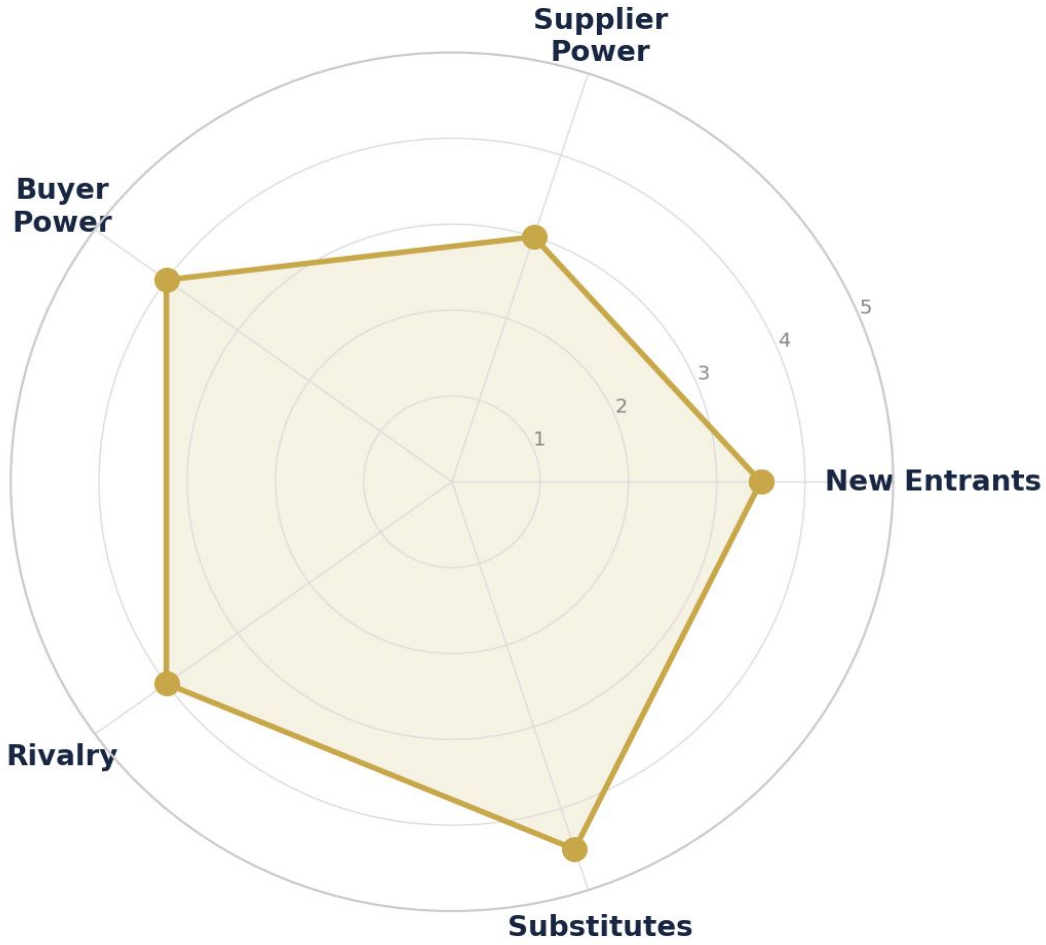
Addressable GMV per campus at a mid-sized U.S. university



Porter's Five Forces

Highest risk: substitutes & buyer power — biggest moat: .edu trust + network

Force	Level	Key Insight
New Entrants	Moderate–High	Low capital for service models, but customer acquisition costs are steep
Supplier Power	Moderate	Rising dependency on software vendors and labor costs
Buyer Power	High	Low switching costs, price-sensitive students, seasonal demand
Rivalry	High	REITs vs. independents competing on price and introductory offers
Substitutes	High	U-Haul, friends' apartments, selling furniture and rebuying



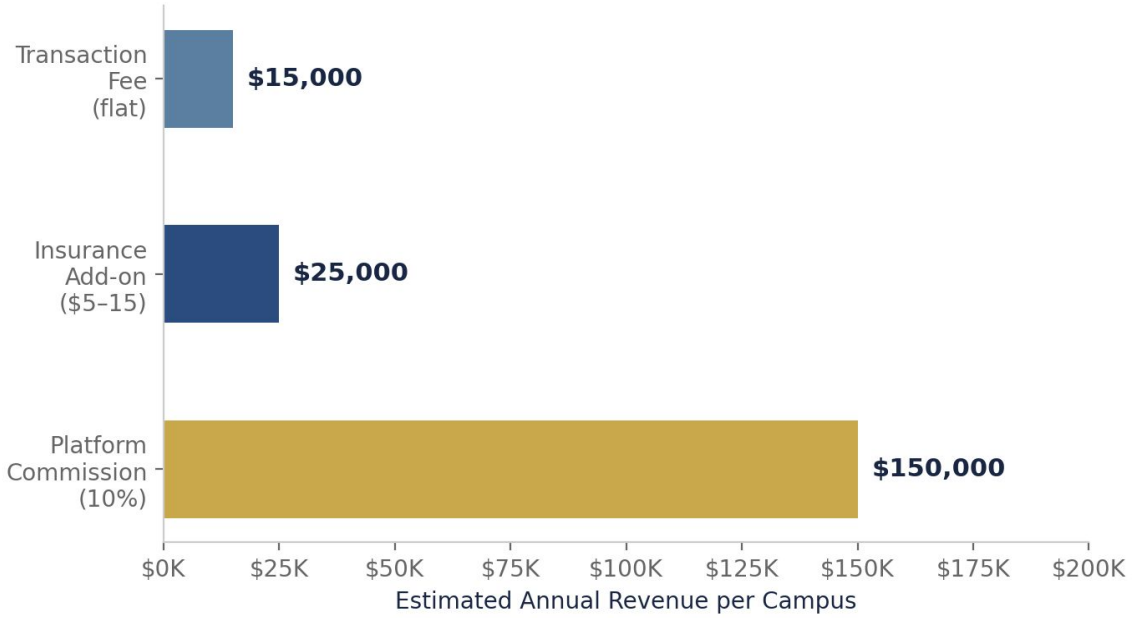
Strategy & Revenue Model

Narrow Differentiation — community trust over price competition

GENERIC STRATEGY

Narrow Differentiation

Targets university students specifically — not the broader storage market. Competes on community trust (.edu wall), convenience (on-campus), and flexibility (1-week minimum) rather than price.



VALUE PROPOSITION

Hyper-local

Units in the same dorms where students already live

Ultra-short terms

1-week minimum vs. monthly commitments at competitors

Verified community

.edu wall creates trust commercial providers can't replicate

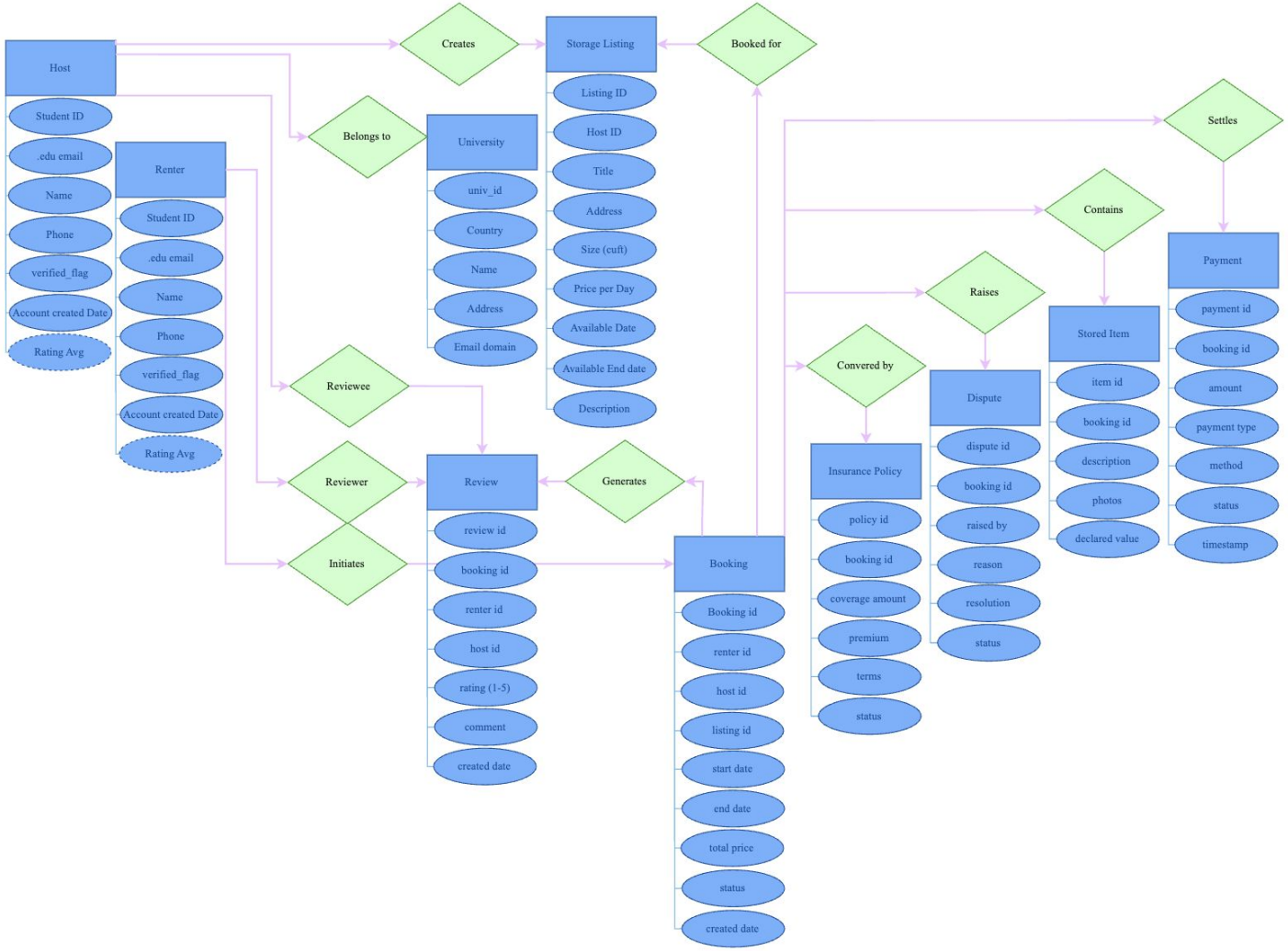
SECTION 03

Information Design

Entity-Relationship Diagram — 9 entities, 2 associative

Entity-Relationship Diagram

9 entities across 3 functional layers — Booking is the central hub



Actor & Identity

Student, University

Core Transactions

StorageListing, Booking*, StoredItem, Payment

Trust & Risk

Review*, Dispute, InsurancePolicy

** Associative entity*

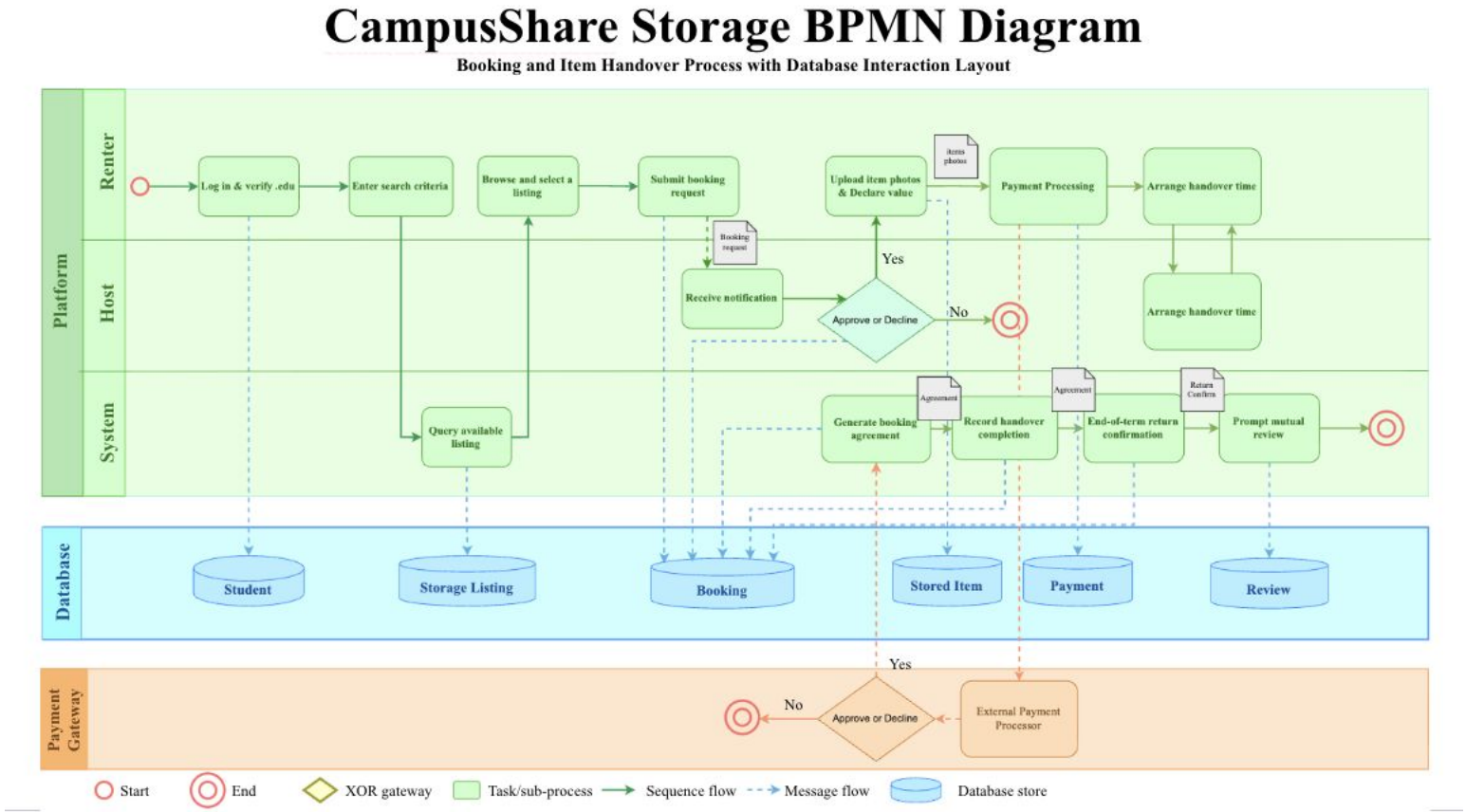
SECTION 04

Business Execution

Value chain mapping & BPMN process model

Booking & Handover Process

Primary revenue-generating workflow — 14 activities, 2 sub-processes, 4 stages



Stage 1

Search & Select

.edu login → query listings → submit booking

Stage 2

Confirmation

Host approves → item photos → payment → agreement

Stage 3

Handover

Campus meetup → timestamped confirmation → active

Stage 4

Closeout

Return handover → completed → mutual reviews

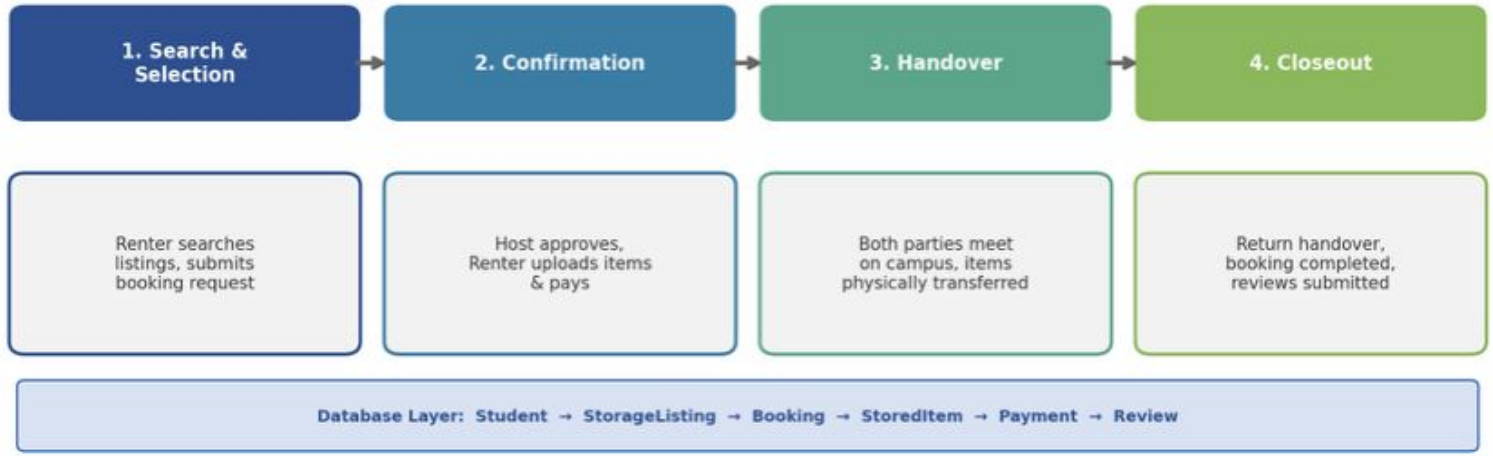
SECTION 05

Critical Reflection & Closing

Ethics, limitations & future developments

Value Chain — Primary Activities

Every activity is scoped to the campus boundary — complexity scales with campus size, not geography



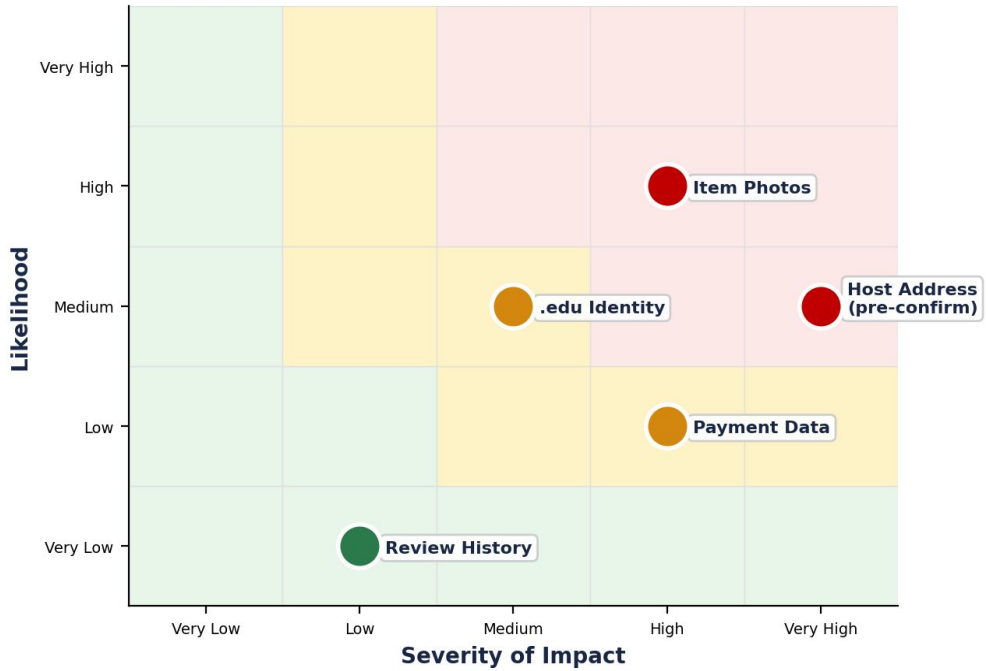
Framework: Porter (1985). Focused Differentiation strategy: campus-scoped operations keep overhead proportional to enrollment, not geographic reach.

Ethics: Combined Data Exposure Risk

No single data point is dangerous — the combination is

CampusShare collects three data types that are individually routine but collectively sensitive: verified student identity, Host residential address, and itemised item photographs with declared values. Combined, they create a "who has what, where" profile that could enable targeted theft if exposed.

This risk disproportionately affects international students, who may face language barriers with law enforcement and lack local support networks.



DESIGN MITIGATIONS

Encrypted photos

Visible only to confirmed Renter; auto-purged 90 days post-booking

Address withheld

Neighbourhood-level only during browsing; full address after confirmation

Neutral drop-off

Hosts can elect campus-designated public location for all handovers

Limitations & Future Developments

Acknowledged constraints and the roadmap ahead

CURRENT LIMITATIONS

- Single-campus scope — no cross-campus or inter-city bookings
- Cold-start trust problem — sparse reviews for early adopters
- Insurance claim workflow not fully modelled in BPMN
- No admin/support entity in the ERD
- Prohibited items assumed but not encoded in data model

FUTURE DEVELOPMENTS

Cross-campus network

Connect universities in the same metro area

ML-based matching

Predict listing compatibility from item types & space attributes

Dynamic pricing

Rates adjust to real-time supply and demand signals

Logistics add-on

Student couriers for pickup and delivery

Licensed insurance

Formal partnership for standardised, regulated coverage

One campus. One community. One trusted marketplace.

01 **.edu Identity Wall**

Only verified students participate

02 **Dual-Direction Reviews**

Trust compounds with every transaction

03 **Deposit-Escrow**

Aligned incentives for both parties

$1.5M GMV addressable per campus • First-mover advantage = brand + reviews + relationships

Thank you — we're happy to take questions.